



BY PRATHAP C. REDDY

A Plea for Holistic Well-being

The next five years are going to be crucial. India needs to transcend not just its present limitations in healthcare but embrace a vision for holistic well-being of its citizens

AS WE STAND AT the threshold of a new era, the potential for transformative change in India is both palpable and promising. The next five years present a critical window of opportunity for our nation to shape its trajectory, and central to this vision must be the prioritisation of healthcare. As Chairman of Apollo Hospitals, I see a vision that extends beyond healthcare to encompass holistic well-being and progress.

The trajectory of life expectancy in India from the 1960s to 2013 has undergone a remarkable transformation. Currently, an 80-year-old patient grappling with health issues stands a significantly improved chance of survival and a healthier life, owing to technological advancements in healthcare, the expertise of skilled clinicians, myriad therapeutic treatments and a comprehensive array of preventive health offerings and platforms.

These elements collectively contribute to ensuring a higher quality of life for individuals in the decades to come.

Healthcare Transformation

A nation's progress is intricately linked to the health of its citizens. Therefore, a robust and inclusive healthcare system should be our foremost priority. Over the past 40 years, non-communicable diseases (NCDs) have changed the world. They have become the leading cause of death and suffering in most countries, contributing to 71% of global deaths. Close to 30% of these are those between 30 and 60 years of age. Alarming, WHO also predicts one in four Indians has a risk of dying from an NCD before they reach the age of 70. This health crisis not only affects individuals but also poses a substantial economic burden. A World Economic Forum report estimates that India could

incur a staggering cost of \$4.58 trillion between 2012 and 2030 due to NCDs and mental health conditions. Preventive healthcare measures have never been more important. Prevention is not just better than cure; it is the foundation of a healthier society.

Harnessing the Power of Technology

The digital revolution is upon us, and we must harness its power to revolutionise healthcare delivery. India has taken rapid strides here and digital health is bringing healthcare within the reach of 70% of our population residing in rural and remote areas. We are positioned to not only bridge gaps in our healthcare delivery but also to

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INDIA'S MOONSHOT FOR HEALTH EQUITY LIES IN EMBRACING AND LEVERAGING MEDICAL TECHNOLOGY, TREATMENT AND RESEARCH